

Summary of Some Common Distributions

Name and parameters	Possible values	pmf/pdf	cdf	Mean	SD
Discrete					
Poisson(μ)	$x = 0, 1, 2, \dots$	$e^{-\mu} \frac{\mu^x}{x!}$	No closed form	μ	$\sqrt{\mu}$
Binomial(n, p)	$x = 0, 1, 2, \dots, n$	$\binom{n}{x} p^x (1-p)^{n-x}$	No closed form	np	$\sqrt{np(1-p)}$
Geometric(p)	$x = 1, 2, 3, \dots$	$p(1-p)^{x-1}$	$1 - (1-p)^x$	$\frac{1}{p}$	$\sqrt{\frac{1-p}{p^2}}$
Continuous					
Uniform(a, b)	$a < x < b$	$\frac{1}{b-a}$	$\frac{x-a}{b-a}$	$\frac{a+b}{2}$	$\frac{b-a}{\sqrt{12}}$
Exponential(λ)	$x > 0$	$\lambda e^{-\lambda x}$	$1 - e^{-\lambda x}$	$\frac{1}{\lambda}$	$\frac{1}{\lambda}$
Normal(μ, σ)	$-\infty < x < \infty$	$\frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{x-\mu}{\sigma}\right)^2\right)$	No closed form (use tables)	μ	σ